

# Program Outcomes and Gaps - Evidence Summary

This packet explains the difference between what major federal programs promised and what they delivered. All findings are based on official audits, GAO reports, and federal oversight documents. Everything is written in simple, clear language so any reader can understand it.

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## PO1 - Housing Choice Vouchers

Plain Summary: This program gives low-income families help paying rent.

Promise: To help low-income families afford safe and decent homes.

What Actually Happened: Many families cannot find landlords who accept vouchers, so vouchers go unused.

Key Findings: Waitlists are long; landlords often refuse vouchers; rents rise faster than voucher values.

Official Evidence Says: Voucher usage has dropped in many areas because families cannot find units.

Sources: HUD OIG Audit; GAO Voucher Monitoring; HUD Voucher Dashboard.

Why This Matters: When help cannot be used, families stay in unsafe or unstable housing.

Limitations: Local housing markets vary widely.

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## PO2 - Homelessness Programs

Plain Summary: These programs fund shelters and housing to reduce homelessness.

Promise: To move people from the streets into permanent housing.

What Actually Happened: Unsheltered homelessness has increased in many places.

Key Findings: Shelters are full; counts are inconsistent; new housing is built too slowly.

Official Evidence Says: Unsheltered homelessness has risen since 2016 in many regions.

Sources: HUD AHAR; GAO Homelessness Reviews; HUD OIG CoC Audits.

Why This Matters: People outside face serious health risks.

Limitations: Counting people without homes is difficult.

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## PO3 - FHFA Duty to Serve

Plain Summary: Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac must support rural and manufactured housing.

Promise: To expand mortgage access for underserved areas.

What Actually Happened: Progress is slow and many families still struggle to get loans.

Key Findings: Some goals met; rural lending still limited; mobile home loans remain scarce.

Official Evidence Says: Plans are often rated as modest with uneven success.

Sources: FHFA Housing Mission Report; FHFA OIG; GAO Housing Finance.

Why This Matters: Without fair loans, families pay higher rates or cannot buy homes.

Limitations: Fannie and Freddie depend on local lenders.

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## **PO4 - EITC and CTC Delivery**

Plain Summary: These tax credits help working families through refunds.

Promise: To reduce poverty and support working parents.

What Actually Happened: Complex rules cause high error rates and delayed refunds.

Key Findings: High improper payment rates; refund freezes delay money; families skip credits due to confusion.

Official Evidence Says: Audits show improper payments remain a major challenge.

Sources: TIGTA EITC Reports; GAO Refundable Credit Review; IRS Advocate Service.

Why This Matters: Delays and errors hurt families who rely on the refund.

Limitations: Self-reporting leaves room for mistakes.

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## **PO5 - SSA COLA Formula**

Plain Summary: Social Security benefits rise each year to match inflation.

Promise: To keep retirees from losing buying power.

What Actually Happened: The formula uses working-age costs, not senior expenses.

Key Findings: CPI-W misses senior spending; medical costs rise faster; seniors lose buying power.

Official Evidence Says: SSA actuaries acknowledge the formula does not match senior needs.

Sources: SSA Trustees Report; BLS CPI-E Data; GAO Retirement Security.

Why This Matters: Retirees slowly fall behind if raises are too small.

Limitations: Congress must change the formula.

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## **PO6 - USDA SNAP**

Plain Summary: SNAP helps families buy groceries.

Promise: To reduce hunger and improve nutrition.

What Actually Happened: Many families still run out of food before month's end.

Key Findings: Benefits often too low; paperwork issues cause churning; child food insecurity remains high.

Official Evidence Says: SNAP reduces poverty but does not end food insecurity.

Sources: USDA Food Security Report; USDA OIG SNAP Audits; GAO SNAP Reports.

Why This Matters: Running out of food harms health and development.

Limitations: SNAP supplements but does not fully cover food costs.

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## **PO7 - HHS Medicaid Access**

Plain Summary: Medicaid provides health coverage for low-income people.

Promise: To ensure access to needed medical care.

What Actually Happened: Many providers do not accept Medicaid due to low pay rates.

Key Findings: Long wait times; ghost networks; few specialists available.

Official Evidence Says: Many listed providers cannot offer appointments.

Sources: HHS OIG Access Review; GAO Medicaid Access; MACPAC Reports.

Why This Matters: Delayed care leads to worse health outcomes.

Limitations: Medicaid rules vary by state.

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